

backwards.

Search STRING forward:

```
/<your string here>.
```

Search STRING backward:

```
?<your string here>
```

You can repeat the search by pressing *n*. To do a repeat search in the opposite direction, use *SHIFT+n*

To search and replace in just one command, VI editor provides substitute functionality with *s*.

The option given below lets users replace the word 'OLD' with 'NEW'. The following command will only replace the first occurrence of the string.

```
:s/OLD/NEW
```

The following option lets the user replace all the occurrences of the word 'OLD' with 'NEW'.

```
:s/OLD/NEW/g
```

There is a lot that can be done in VI. For now, enjoy the above tips.

—Nagesh Bandla,
nag.bandla@gmail.com

The size of the segments in an object file

The *size* command is used to get the total size of the object file along with each segment. This helps developers to understand the memory allocated for each segment. Shown below is an example:

```
test@x24ffr:~$ size a.out
```

text	data	bss	dec	hex	filename
1193	256	8	1457	5b1	a.out

...where,

text: Text Segment

data: Data Segment

bss: bss segment

dec,hex: Total size in decimal and Hex

—Surendra Patil,
suru47@gmail.com

Finding the serial number of the hard disk and tape devices

The *sg3_utils* which is shipped by RedHat can scan SCSI devices for its details. To find the serial number of the tape

drives, run the following command:

```
sginfo -s /dev/sg19
```

```
/dev/sg19 Serial Number 'HU1205LTKF'
```

Now, let us look at different ways by which we can get the serial number of the HDD. There are different commands in Linux that can give you the details of the HDD attached your system. Here is the list that you can use.

```
# lshw -class disk  
*-disk
```

```
description: ATA Disk
```

```
product: Hitachi HTS54505
```

```
vendor: Hitachi
```

```
physical id: 0
```

```
bus info: scsi@0:0.0.0
```

```
logical name: /dev/sda
```

```
version: PB40
```

```
serial: 219418PRH4A5P7CKK2AW
```

```
size: 46561B (500GB)
```

Other commands that will also give the desired output are:

```
# smartctl -i /dev/sda  
# hdparm -i /dev/sda  
# hwinfo -disk  
# ls /dev/disk/by-id
```

—Mohamed Farook A,
mdfarock@gmail.com

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in OSFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.